previous chapter, the two leaderships now met for the first time since the 1960s. Mrs Gandhi and Chinese Premier Hua Guofeng encountered each other at Marshal Tito's funeral in 1980. The following year, the Chinese foreign minister Huang Hua came to Delhi. This led to the resumption of border negotiations for the first time in twenty years and eventually to Rajiv Gandhi's seminal trip to Beijing in 1988.

1989–Present: From Entente to Rivalry to Cold War Rivalry . . . Again

The Cold War lasted forty years. The post–Cold War is already thirty years old. In this no-name period, India's and China's relations with Russia and the US have gone through three decade-long shifts. In the first decade, India and China, along with Russia, held rather similar negative perceptions of a triumphant America and took steps to resist US hegemony. This entente was succeeded by a decade in which India and the US saw a rapidly rising China as a rival. Russia, after hoping it would find a dignified place in the new US-led world order, turned to its great Asian neighbour for succour but kept to a middle position between Delhi and Beijing. The third decade after the end of the Cold War was witness to China's continuing rise and new assertiveness, especially after the global financial crisis of 2008. India–US relations continued to deepen in reaction to China's growing power. Russia partnered China more explicitly while still maintaining a diplomatic and arms relationship with India. In sum, over thirty years, India and China moved from a period of entente-like relations in the shadow of US hegemony to an era in which India increasingly tilted towards the US against China and finally to an outright rivalry, with India partnering the US in a new Cold War. This repeated the cycle of the period 1949–89 in which India and China went from entente partners to Cold War rivals.

1989–1998: Entente